Fraction Bars and Number Lines

TEACHER KEY

3rd Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Build a fraction from unit fractions on a bar and on a number line from 0 to 2. Turn on Compare to find equivalent fractions and compare fractions. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Show 2/3. How many equal parts are in one whole? How many are colored?

   3 equal parts; 2 are colored

2. Where is 1/4 on the number line from 0 to 1?

   At the first mark after 0 when the space from 0 to 1 is cut into 4 equal parts

3. Find a fraction equal to 2/4.

   1/2 (or 4/8, or 3/6)

4. Compare 2/6 and 5/6. Write >, = or <.

   2/6 < 5/6

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Explore more

5. Compare 1/3 and 1/6. Write >, = or <.

1/3 > 1/6, because thirds are bigger parts than sixths

6. What whole number is 8/8? What whole number is 6/3?

8/8 = 1 and 6/3 = 2

Reflect

7. Reflect: Why is 1/8 smaller than 1/4 even though 8 is bigger than 4?

The whole is cut into more parts, so each part is smaller.

Teacher notes

- Keep both bars and number lines visible so students connect the area model with the length model.
- Use Compare to find all fractions equal to 1/2 with denominators 2, 4, 6 and 8.
- Fractions up to 2 let students see whole numbers as fractions (3.NF.A.3c): 4/4 = 1, 6/3 = 2.

Standards: 3.NF.A.1, 3.NF.A.2, 3.NF.A.3. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool's picture.